

Chapter 24-2

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The early autumn evening breeze carried a hint of coolness. Liang Shi carried Xu Qingzhu hurriedly downstairs.

Xu Qingzhu was draped in her jacket. Usually she looked quite tall, but now curled up in Liang Shi's arms, she appeared small and delicate. However, her hands were restless, wandering from her lower abdomen to her chest.

Even through the clothing, she could touch softness.

Liang Shi was nearly made to groan several times by her touches. Fortunately, her jacket provided cover, preventing the actions from being too explicit.

Xu Qingya followed alongside them all the way. As they went downstairs, she mentioned, "Sister Xining hasn't come down yet."

"Let's take your sister to the hospital first," Liang Shi said. "We can't worry about so much. Zhao Xuning is a doctor—she'll handle things herself."

Xu Qingya helped open the car door, and Liang Shi placed Xu Qingzhu in the back seat.

But Xu Qingzhu clung to her arm, refusing to let go. As if she could touch something that would cool her burning body, her soft, boneless hand fell on Liang Shi's wrist, gently stroking it. It didn't seem like deliberate seduction—just instinctive action.

Not trying to be alluring, yet more alluring than any attempt.

Liang Shi felt an unknown fire rising in her lower abdomen. Her whole body felt tingly, the sensation traveling from her wrist all the way to her toes. She couldn't help but lick her lips as she coaxed softly, "Bamboo¹, be good, let go."

Her voice was gentle, trying to maintain a cool tone, but if you listened carefully, you could hear her voice trembling at the end.

Physical instinct made her unable to control herself.

But she knew that while Xu Qingzhu was no longer clear-headed, she herself was still conscious.

Taking advantage of Xu Qingzhu's disoriented state would be too shameless.

Liang Shi considered herself at least somewhat of a gentleman.

Who would have thought that not only did Xu Qingzhu not let go upon hearing her words, but her fingers traveled upward from her wrist to her forearm, lightly pinching the flesh on her arm.

There wasn't much flesh there, but the spot she pinched felt somehow itchy.

Not just that patch of skin—her entire body felt itchy.

A tingling, numbing kind of itch.

Liang Shi suspected Xu Qingzhu had cast some spell on her hands.

She took a deep breath and said gently, "Bamboo, I'll take you to the hospital. Let go first, okay?"

"No..." Xu Qingzhu frowned like a child. "I don't want to go to the hospital."

She had first drunk too much alcohol, then because her inhibitor had failed, she had accidentally ingested an aphrodisiac². Her current state could hardly be called ideal.

The fact that she hadn't pleased herself in public was already a testament to her strong mental self-control.

Though her two legs were also constantly rubbing together.

Earlier on the way, she had even guided Liang Shi's hand to explore herself.

Liang Shi had been so startled she nearly dropped her.

At this moment, Liang Shi was screaming internally, but could only continue coaxing, "Then we won't go. I'll take you home, okay? You'll feel better after sleeping at home."

Xu Qingzhu suddenly covered her mouth and dry heaved.

"Careful, she's going to throw up," Xu Qingya said urgently.

Liang Shi quickly moved aside to give her space, but after breathing in some fresh air, Xu Qingzhu felt slightly better.

She shook her head, looking pitiful and wronged.

Inexplicably, Liang Shi thought of the cat she used to have.

Actually, it wasn't really her cat.

She had picked it up on her way back to the hotel after finishing work late one day.

It was raining heavily that day, and the cat was huddled in a small shelter by the roadside. In the fierce wind, it curled up its body, constantly sticking out its tongue to lick its fur.

Liang Shi had been moved by pity and brought it home to care for it.

It had indeed kept Liang Shi company for a while.

During those lonely years, that cat had briefly healed her.

Perhaps she wasn't meant to be with these little creatures.

After raising it for less than a year, it died.

But Liang Shi clearly remembered that when the cat was scolded by her, or when it had secretly drunk the wine she had hidden at home, it would have an expression very similar to Xu Qingzhu's current one.

Both would look at you pitifully, eyes misty with tears, with a somewhat dazed look, as if seeking forgiveness, yet also as if saying aggrievedly: "I didn't do anything—"

Liang Shi characterized this as having a righteous air even when in the wrong.

"I won't throw up," Xu Qingzhu bit her lower lip and said with a sob, "Take me home, okay?"

There was a hint of pleading, but her tone was clearly acting spoiled.

Liang Shi's heart filled with even more tender affection. She nodded firmly, "Okay, we'll go home. But you need to let go of me first so I can drive."

Xu Qingzhu looked at her, the misty vapor in her eyes turning into teardrops that fell on her flushed cheeks. There was also a teardrop hanging on her long eyelashes, making her look pitiful and wronged, like a fragile porcelain doll.

Liang Shi: "....."

Help!

No one told her that Xu Qingzhu's personality would change so drastically when drunk!

She had thought she was a gentle goddess, then discovered she was an aloof beauty, and now found out she was the pure and cute type.

In any case, there were surprises every day.

Liang Shi was having trouble handling this.

Anyone would have trouble handling this.

Liang Shi thought that if Xu Qingzhu asked her right now, "Take me to the moon, okay?" she would definitely agree unconditionally.

That kind of impulsive, reckless behavior.

Perhaps at this moment, she understood King You of Zhou's³ actions a little bit.

Although when she had read this story before, she thought King You of Zhou was just a foolish ruler, an idiot.

How could there be such people in this world?

But now she felt she had been too young back then.

"Liang... Shi~" Xu Qingzhu called her name softly, her voice rising at the end, as if the sound was made by gently biting the tip of her tongue.

Liang Shi's legs went weak, but she managed to hold herself up without embarrassing herself. She responded softly, her voice also gentle, "I'm here, what's wrong?"

Xu Qingzhu gripped her arm tightly, her head gently nuzzling against her, her hair falling just at her collarbone.

Some strands even slipped inside her clothes along the neckline, touching her skin.

Xu Qingzhu looked at her and suddenly smiled—a smile that made one lose focus momentarily.

Liang Shi swallowed and coaxed again, "Bamboo, let go, okay?"

"No." Xu Qingzhu's voice had a slightly nasal tone. She frowned slightly, and as if thinking of something, suddenly licked her lips. "Meow~"

Liang Shi: "....."

Her heart skipped a beat for a moment.

When she made the cat sound, her expression was fifty percent similar to a cat's.

But she was much more seductive than a cat.

She just lightly licked her lips, and they glistened with a rippling red, as if coated with the finest lip gloss, without any added color—just the most natural hue of the body.

Footnotes:

¹ Bamboo: Liang Shi's nickname for Xu Qingzhu (since "zhu" means bamboo)

² Aphrodisiac: A drug that increases sexual desire

³ King You of Zhou: An ancient Chinese ruler famous for his foolish behavior to please his beloved concubine, ultimately leading to his downfall